



ANCIENT EGYPT

A LAND OF THE NILE, PYRAMIDS
AND PHaraohs



READING PASSAGE



Thousands of years ago, along the banks of the Nile River in north-east Africa, a remarkable civilisation began to grow. This civilisation was Ancient Egypt.



The Nile River was the heart of Egypt. Each year, the river flooded its banks and left behind rich, black soil. This made the land perfect for growing crops such as wheat, barley, flax and vegetables. Because of this, many Egyptians were farmers who depended on the Nile for food, water and life.



The Egyptians built some of the world's most incredible structures. The most famous are the pyramids of Giza. These huge stone buildings were built as tombs for the pharaohs, who were the kings of Egypt. Pharaohs were believed to be chosen by the gods, and the Egyptians thought they would live on in the afterlife.



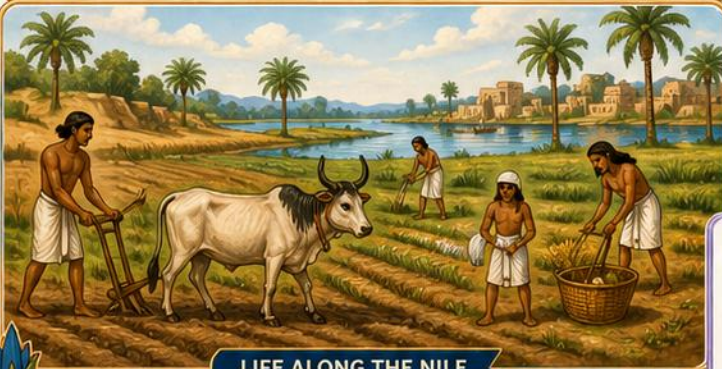
Religion was extremely important in Ancient Egypt. The people believed in many gods and goddesses, each with different roles. Ra was the sun god, Isis was the goddess of magic and motherhood, and Anubis was the god of the afterlife. Temples were built to honour the gods and goddesses.



The Ancient Egyptians also developed a system of writing called hieroglyphics. Instead of letters, they used pictures and symbols to write on stone walls, papyrus paper and monuments. Hieroglyphics were used for important messages, stories and records.



Ancient Egypt lasted for more than 3,000 years. It left behind an amazing legacy in art, architecture, writing, medicine and science that still influences the world today.



LIFE ALONG THE NILE



COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1 LITERAL QUESTIONS (Find it in the text)

a) Where was Ancient Egypt located?

b) Why was the Nile River so important?

c) What were pyramids used for?



2 VOCABULARY

a) What does the word **civilisation** mean?

b) What are **hieroglyphics**?



3 INFERENTIAL QUESTIONS (Think deeper)

a) Why do you think Egyptians believed the Nile was so important to their survival?

b) What does the text suggest about how Egyptians viewed their pharaohs?



4 CREATIVE THINKING

a) Imagine you are an Ancient Egyptian farmer. Describe your daily life.

b) If you could build a pyramid today, what would you put inside and why?



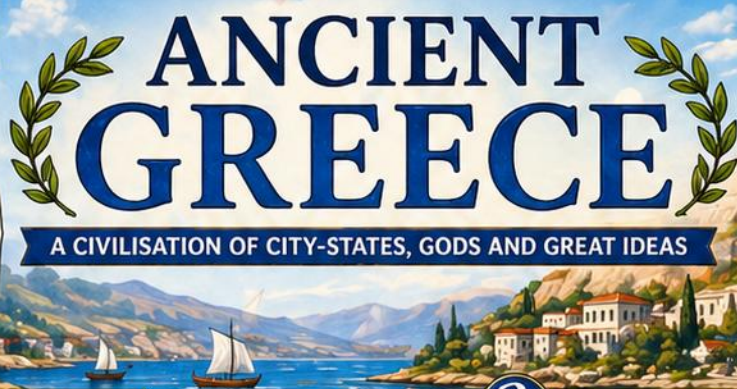
CHALLENGE TASK

Draw and label a scene of life in Ancient Egypt. Include at least **THREE** important features from the text (e.g. Nile River, pyramids, farming, gods, hieroglyphics).



ANCIENT GREECE

A CIVILISATION OF CITY-STATES, GODS AND GREAT IDEAS



READING PASSAGE



Ancient Greece was a civilisation that thrived over 2,500 years ago in southeastern Europe. It was not ruled by one king or empire, but made up of many independent city-states, such as Athens, Sparta and Corinth. Each city-state had its own laws, government and army.



The Greeks valued learning, art and philosophy. Great thinkers like Socrates, Plato and Aristotle asked big questions about life, knowledge and the world around us. Their ideas still influence us today.



Democracy – a system where citizens have a say in how they are ruled – began in Athens. In this system, free men could vote on important decisions about their city.



Ancient Greeks believed in many gods and goddesses, such as Zeus, the king of the gods, and Athena, the goddess of wisdom. They built beautiful temples in their honour.



The Olympics began in Greece over 2,700 years ago. The games were held every four years in honour of Zeus and included events like running, wrestling and chariot races.



The achievements of Ancient Greece in science, maths, art, literature and government have had a lasting impact on the world we live in today.



VOCABULARY FOCUS

civilisation – a society with its own culture and way of life

city-state – an independent city and the surrounding land

democracy – a system of government where people have a say

philosophy – the study of big questions about life and the world



COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1 LITERAL – Find the answers in the text.

a) Where was Ancient Greece located?

b) Name two city-states in Ancient Greece.

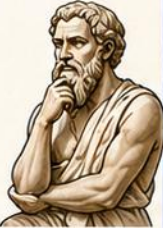
c) What began in Athens?



2 INFERENTIAL – Think deeper.

a) Why do you think the Greeks valued learning and philosophy so much?

b) What might be some advantages of living in a city-state instead of a large empire?



3 VOCABULARY – Use the text to help you.

a) What does the word *civilisation* mean in this text?

b) Find a word in the text that means the same as "honour".



4 APPLIED KNOWLEDGE – Use what you know.

a) If you could have lived in Ancient Greece, would you have preferred to live in Athens or Sparta? Why?



CHALLENGE TASK

Choose one achievement of Ancient Greece (e.g. democracy, the Olympics, philosophy, art or architecture). Research it and create a poster to explain why it is still important today. Include pictures and key facts.



The past shapes our future.
Learn from the Greeks!

ANCIENT CHINA

A CIVILISATION OF GREAT INVENTIONS,
DYNASTIES AND ENDURING LEGACIES



READING PASSAGE



Ancient China began more than 4,000 years ago along the banks of the Huang He (Yellow River). This fertile land helped farmers grow crops such as rice, millet and wheat, supporting growing communities.



Over time, many dynasties ruled China, including the Shang, Zhou, Qin and Han. Each dynasty made lasting contributions to Chinese culture, government and society.



The Ancient Chinese made remarkable achievements that still influence our world today. They invented paper, printing, the compass and gunpowder. They also developed advanced farming techniques and built impressive structures like the Great Wall of China, which was built to protect the country from invaders.



Confucius, a famous philosopher and teacher, taught that people should be kind, respectful and honest. His ideas about how to live a good life and create a peaceful society are still important in Chinese culture today.



Ancient China's rich history of innovation, wisdom and perseverance has left a lasting legacy that continues to inspire the world.



DID YOU KNOW?

The Great Wall of China is over 21,000 kilometres long! It was built over many dynasties and took thousands of years to complete.



VOCABULARY FOCUS

civilisation – a society with its own culture and way of life

dynasty – a line of rulers from the same family

invention – something new that has been created

philosopher – a person who studies big ideas about life and the world



COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1 LITERAL – Find the answers in the text.

- Where did Ancient China begin?

- Name two crops that farmers grew in Ancient China.

- What are two inventions that Ancient Chinese people created?



2 INFERENTIAL – Think deeper.

- Why do you think the Ancient Chinese built the Great Wall?

- How might Confucius' teachings have helped people live together peacefully?



3 VOCABULARY – Use the text to help you.

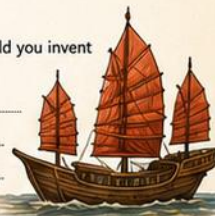
- What does the word *civilisation* mean in this text?

- Find a word in the text that means the same as "lasting".



4 APPLIED KNOWLEDGE – Use what you know.

- If you could be an inventor in Ancient China, what would you invent and why?



CHALLENGE TASK

Choose one achievement of Ancient China (e.g. an invention, the Great Wall, Confucius' teachings). Research it and create a poster or a comic strip to explain why it was important. Include pictures and key facts.

